(or you can download it online). You can also download the binary for Windows OS from https://curl.se/windows.

Open a new terminal window, and type in the following:

```
$>curl http://localhost:9200
```

The response indicates that the Elasticsearch server is working well (obviously, the version number will be different when you run on your local setup). The most important property is `cluster_name`. The default value is `"elasticsearch"`. If you are starting up a new node and wish to join this cluster (`elasticsearch`), all you have to do is to set `cluster_name` in the properties file to match the first server's `cluster_name` property.

A.1.4 Installing via Docker

If you are going the route of using Docker, you can do so two ways, as described here.

Using the Docker image

Elastic publishes its Docker images in the docker.elastic.co repository. Pull the image from Elastic's docker repo:

```
docker pull docker.elastic.co/elasticsearch/elasticsearch:8.6.2
```

This fetches the image (which is based on CentOS) to your local machine. Once the image is downloaded, you can start your server by invoking the `docker run` command:

```
docker run -p 9200:9200 -p 9300:9300 -e "discovery.type=single-node"
     docker.elastic.co/elasticsearch/elasticsearch:8.6.2
```

This command starts the server in single-node mode, exposing the server at 9200 on your localhost.

After the command executes successfully, visit http://localhost:9200 on your browser (or issue a `curl` command) to receive a positive response from the server.

Using docker-compose

The book's files include Docker files in the docker folder at http://mng.bz/5wvD or on the book's website. Copy (or check out to your local machine) the elasticsearch-docker-8-6-2.yml file. Issue the following command at the terminal:

```
docker-compose up -f elasticsearch-docker-8-6-2.yml
```

This command kick-starts your Docker container with both Elasticsearch and Kibana services.

A.1.5 Testing the server with the _cat API

Elasticsearch is a RESTful web server, meaning communicating with it is very easy. Elasticsearch exposes a special API called cat (compact and aligned text) with the `_cat` endpoint. While JSON formats are computer friendly, it would be uncomfortable for humans to read data in that format. The `_cat` API is not for programmatic